06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | DESK REFERENCE

Clear Request Checklist

Use this for a decision request, an escalation, or a follow-up on an open item.

Step	Ask yourself before you send
1. Name the exact decision	Will the reader know exactly what answer, approval, or clarification I need?
2. Check authority and boundaries	What can I decide or keep doing? What needs someone else's approval?
3. Gather facts and required input	What do I know for sure? What is still unconfirmed? Whose input do I need?
4. Offer options and a recommendation	What are the realistic options? Which one do I recommend, and why?
5. Use the correct route and verify timing	Who makes the decision? Is the deadline real? When will I get a reply or update?
6. Track the reply and close the loop	Who will track the request, do the next step, and update others?

Track three dates

Decision needed by: _____ **Reply expected by:** _____

Next update, if still open: _____ **Confirmed with:** _____

Following up on a request

Refer to your original request and the update date you agreed on. Say what is still unanswered, any new facts, and what happens if the decision waits. Check for a reply before you send a second request.

> **Response times and urgent issues**
> Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it will take longer, you should get a date for the next update. Immediate risks and required deadlines go through the urgent process.

Source: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.